

167. Chapter 14 Verses 16-20

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 14.16

कर्मणः सुकृतस्याहुः सात्त्विकं निर्मलं फलम् ।
रजसस्तु फलं दुःखमज्ञानं तमसः फलम् ॥ 16 ॥

karmaṇaḥ sukṛitasyāhuḥ sāttvikam nirmalam phalam
rajasas tu phalam duḥkham ajñānam tamasaḥ phalam

karmaṇaḥ—of action; **su-kṛitasya**—pure; **āhuḥ**—is said; **sāttvikam**—mode of goodness; **nirmalam**—pure; **phalam**—result; **rajasah**—mode of passion; **tu**—indeed; **phalam**—result; **duḥkham**—pain; **ajñānam**—ignorance; **tamasaḥ**—mode of ignorance; **phalam**—result

The fruit of a good action is said to be good and clean; the fruit of rajas is pain; and the fruit of tamas is ignorance.

VERSE 14.17

सत्त्वात्सञ्जायते ज्ञानं रजसो लोभ एव च ।
प्रमादमोहौ तमसो भवतोऽज्ञानमेव च ॥ 17 ॥

sattvāt sañjāyate jñānam rajaso lobha eva cha
pramāda-mohau tamaso bhavato 'jñānam eva cha

sattvāt—from the mode of goodness; **sañjāyate**—arises; **jñānam**—knowledge; **rajasah**—from the mode of passion; **lobhah**—greed; **eva**—indeed; **cha**—and; **pramāda**—negligence; **mohau**—delusion; **tamasah**—from the mode of ignorance; **bhavatah**—arise; **ajñānam**—ignorance; **eva**—indeed; **cha**—and

**From sattva springs knowledge, and from rajas, greed; from
tamas spring inadvertence, delusion, and ignorance.**

VERSE 14.18

ऊर्ध्वं गच्छन्ति सत्त्वस्था मध्ये तिष्ठन्ति राजसाः ।
जघन्यगुणवृत्तिस्था अधो गच्छन्ति तामसाः ॥ 18 ॥

ūrdhvam gachchhanti sattva-sthā madhye tiṣṭhanti rājasāḥ
jaghanya-guṇa-vṛitti-sthā adho gachchhanti tāmasāḥ

ūrdhvam—upward; **gachchhanti**—rise; **sattva-sthāḥ**—those situated in the mode of goodness; **madhye**—in the middle; **tiṣṭhanti**—stay; **rājasāḥ**—those in the mode of passion; **jaghanya**—abominable; **guṇa**—quality; **vṛitti-sthāḥ**—engaged in activities; **adhaḥ**—down; **gachchhanti**—go; **tāmasāḥ**—those in the mode of ignorance

Those who are established in sattva go upward; those who are moved by rajas remain in the middle; and those who are steeped in tamas, being weighted by the tendencies of the lowest guna, go downward.

VERSE 14.19

नान्यं गुणेभ्यः कर्तारं यदा द्रष्टानुपश्यति ।
गुणेभ्यश्च परं वेत्ति मद्भावं सोऽधिगच्छति ॥ 19 ॥

nānyam guṇebhyaḥ kartāraṁ yadā draṣṭānupaśhyati
guṇebhyaśh cha paraṁ vetti mad-bhāvaṁ so 'dhigachchhati

na—no; anyam—other; guṇebhyaḥ—of the guṇas; kartāraṁ—agents of action; yadā—when; draṣṭā—the seer; anupaśhyati—see; guṇebhyaḥ—to the modes of nature; cha—and; paraṁ—transcendental; vetti—know; mad-bhāvaṁ—my divine nature; saḥ—they; adhigachchhati—attain

**When a man of insight beholds no agent other than the
gunas, and also knows Him who is beyond the gunas, he
attains My being.**

VERSE 14.20

गुणानेतानतीत्य त्रीन्देही देहसमुद्भवान् ।
जन्ममृत्युजरादुःखैर्विमुक्तोऽमृतमश्नुते ॥ 20 ॥

guṇān etān atītya trīn dehī deha-samudbhavān
janma-mṛityu-jarā-duḥkhair vimukto 'mṛitam aśhnute

guṇān—the three modes of material nature; **etān**—these; **atītya**—transcending;
trīn—three; **dehī**—the embodied; **deha**—body; **samudbhavān**—produced of;
janma—birth; **mṛityu**—death; **jarā**—old age; **duḥkhair**—misery; **vimuktaḥ**—
free from; **amṛitam**—immortality; **aśhnute**—attains

When the embodied soul has risen above the three gunas of which its body is made, it gains deliverance from birth, death, old age, and pain and becomes immortal.